Saverio Spinella

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Education

New York University — New York, US
PhD in Economics — 2022 – present

Bocconi University — Milan, IT
Master in Economics and Social Sciences — 2019 – 2021

Bocconi University — Milan, IT
BSc in International Economics and Finance — 2016 – 2019

Published/ Accepted Papers

More on onetary Economics
with Guido Menzio
Forthcoming in the Economic Journal
Does the cashless limit of the monetary equilibrium converge to the non-monetary equilibrium? We revisit the question in the context of Menzio and Spinella (2025), a model in which the financial market where households lend savings and firms borrow capital is subject to trading frictions. The fraction of households that do not meet any firms determines money demand. The relative fractions of households that meet one and multiple firms determines the extent of competition in the financial market, and the sensitivity of interest rates to the rate of return on money (the household's option outside of the market). The cashless limit of the monetary equilibrium converges to the non-monetary equilibrium depending on whether the financial market becomes perfectly competitive, which, in turn, depends on the exact specification of the trading frictions. For one specification, the cashless limit converges to the non-monetary equilibrium, as in Woodford (1998). For another specification, it does not, as in Lagos and Zhang (2022). For both specifications, the non-monetary equilibrium is a quantitatively poor approximation of the monetary equilibrium given actual money demand.

Working Papers

A Macroeconomic Theory of Imperfect Competition in Financial Markets
with Guido Menzio
Revise and Resubmit at Journal of Political Economy, NBER Working Paper 33868
We develop a macroeconomic model in which households are subject to uninsurable shocks to their endowment of labor, as in Aiyagari (1994), the financial market where households lend and firms borrow capital is subject to search frictions, as in Burdett and Judd (1983), and households invest in their ability to search. The model generates dispersion in the returns offered by firms for equally risky assets, persistent heterogeneity in the returns earned by households holding equally risky portfolios, and a positive correlation between wealth and risk-adjusted returns. These objects are endogenous, and depend on the marginal product of capital, the inflation rate, and the distribution of financial knowledge among households. A calibrated version of the model is used to quantify the effect of monetary, technology and policy shocks on financial market outcomes and, in particular, on the relationship between wealth and returns.

Work in Progress

The Inequality Multiplier

Consumption Sorting and Inequality
with Tommaso De Santo

Gatekeeping Capital
with Suk-Joon Kim

The Distributional Impacts of Decarbonization Policies
with Rafael Dix-Carneiro, Jeffrey Sun, Sharon Traiberman
Decarbonization policies can impose highly uneven costs across workers, industries, and regions, making their distributional consequences central to both policy design and political feasibility. We quantify these effects using a dynamic spatial general-equilibrium model of the United States. The model integrates costly trade, input-output linkages, imperfect worker mobility, irreversible capital accumulation, and an electricity sector with renewable and fossil-fuel generation connected through an interstate transmission network. We discipline the model using detailed data on production, trade, worker flows, electricity generation, capacity, prices, and interstate flows. A 20% carbon tax reduces fossil-fuel production by about 35% within five years and by 38–42% in the long run, but its incidence depends critically on how revenues are redistributed. Renewable subsidies accelerate the transition to clean electricity and reduce aggregate welfare losses, while uniform rebates substantially reduce the losses borne by workers. Under renewable subsidies, rapid investment in clean generation combined with the slow retirement of irreversible fossil-fuel capacity produces a substantial temporary expansion in generating capacity and lower electricity prices during the transition. Losses nevertheless remain highly concentrated in fossil-fuel-producing regions and carbon-intensive industries.

Predoctoral Work

Robot Adoption, Worker-Firm Sorting and Wage Inequality: Evidence from Administrative Panel Data
with Ester Faia and Gianmarco Ottaviano
CEPR Discussion Paper 17451

Conferences

2025: Rice-LEMMA Monetary Conference, SED Annual Meeting
2026: DC Search and Match, Search and Matching Network Annual Conference, Barcelona Summer Forum, SED Annual Meeting

Teaching experience

Instructor — Summer 2026
New York University
Intro to Econometrics (undergraduate)

Teaching Assistant — 2023–present
New York University
International Economics (undergraduate)
Intermediate Macroeconomics (undergraduate)
Markets with Frictions (undergraduate)
Math for Economists (graduate)
Labor Economics (undergraduate)

Teaching Assistant
Bocconi University — 2022
International Economics and Finance (undergraduate)

Professional Service

Referee for *The Economic Journal*, *Review of Economic Dynamics*.

Research experience

Research Assistant — 2021–2022
Supervisors: Professor E. Faia (Goethe University Frankfurt)
Professor G.I.P. Ottaviano (Bocconi University)

Research Assistant — 2021
Supervisors: Professor T. Schmitz (Bocconi University),
Professor A. Trigari (Bocconi University)

	Research Assistant Supervisor: Professor I. Colantone (Bocconi University)	2019
Scholarships	MacCracken Fellowship, NYU	2022-present
	Bocconi Graduate Merit Award (renewal)	2020-2021
	Bocconi Graduate Merit Award (Master of Science full tuition waiver)	2019-2020
Skills	**IT Skills** Stata, Matlab, Python, R, Julia	
	Languages Italian (native), English (fluent)	